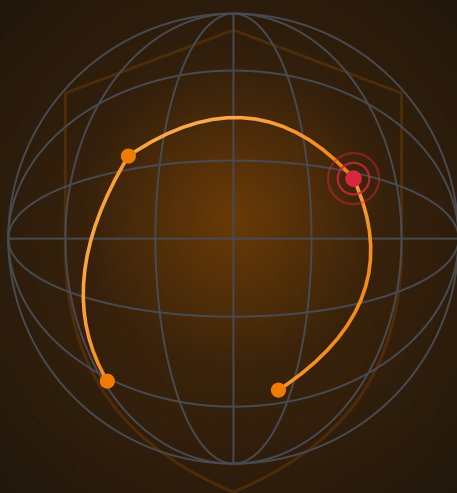




THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 3–9 AUGUST 2026

Inside this week: a **critical flaw in the remote-management tools IT providers use** is under active attack, hackers are **meddling with US water systems**, and a phishing kit is **slipping past multi-factor login** — explained in plain English, with the practical steps that matter.

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves around the world — and what they mean for your business. This week was dominated by a **critical flaw in a tool that IT providers use to manage their clients' computers**, which attackers are already exploiting to reach the businesses behind it — a sharp reminder that your security can depend on your suppliers'. No jargon, just what happened and the practical steps worth taking.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

 **8.2** /10

Severity of the IT-management flaw now being exploited by attackers in the wild

 **3** -day

Emergency deadline the US cyber agency CISA set for federal bodies to patch it

 **55.6** %

Of reachable servers still unpatched days after the fix shipped (Huntress)

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

N-ABLE N-CENTRAL • CVE-2026-18577

Attackers are hijacking the remote-management tools IT providers use to reach your computers



Exploitation: **active & in the wild**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Attackers have found a way to **bypass the login** on **N-able N-central** — a popular platform IT companies use to manage and support their clients' computers remotely. With no password needed, they gain **full "administrator" control** of the tool, then abuse its built-in remote-access feature to push software and commands straight onto the **computers and servers it manages**. The fix shipped on 2 August and attacks began within a day.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Businesses whose **IT support provider** runs its own (self-hosted) copy of N-central — you could be exposed **through your provider** even if you did nothing wrong. The US cyber agency CISA judged it serious enough to give federal bodies just **three days** to patch (by 6 August), and security firms have already seen real break-ins at affected organisations.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

Because the tool has deep access to every machine it manages, a single break-in can reach **many businesses at once** and hand attackers control of your **PCs, servers and even domain controllers** — the kind of foothold that leads to data theft or ransomware.

Good news: N-able's own **cloud-hosted N-central** was **updated automatically**. For most businesses the action is simply to **ask your IT provider** whether they use N-central and, if self-hosted, that it's now patched and checked — there's nothing to install yourself.

What to do about the headline threat

-  Ask your **IT provider** whether they use **N-able N-central** and, if self-hosted, that it's been **updated to version 2026.3.1.7** (the emergency fix).
-  Ask them to **check for signs of intrusion** — unexpected admin accounts, unknown remote-control sessions, or surprise remote-access apps (AnyDesk, TeamViewer, RustDesk).
-  If you run N-central yourself, **patch now** and keep its console **off the open internet**, behind a VPN with multi-factor sign-in.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT



HIGH

Hackers are meddling with US water systems

The **FBI and CISA** warned that attackers are reaching **internet-connected control devices** at water and wastewater plants — changing their settings and passwords and causing **loss of pressure and even flooding**. Compromises have been reported across a growing number of US states since late July.

Takeaway: never leave control panels, cameras or admin devices exposed to the internet — put them behind a firewall/VPN and change any default passwords.



HIGH

Phishing that slips past multi-factor login

A criminal “phishing kit” now tricks **Microsoft 365** users into approving a login **code**, quietly handing attackers access **even when multi-factor authentication is switched on**. Fake voicemail alerts are a common lure.

Takeaway: never enter or approve a login code you didn’t request yourself, and treat unexpected sign-in prompts as suspicious.



MEDIUM

One dental-benefits breach, 15 million people

US dental-benefits administrator **DentaQuest** began notifying more than **15 million people** after an extortion group stole names, **Social Security numbers** and health details and leaked them online — a reminder that your data sits with the suppliers you rely on.

Takeaway: know which third parties hold your data, and ask how they’d tell you — and protect you — if they were breached.

★ Your 3-minute checklist this week

- ✓ Ask your **IT provider** whether they use **N-able N-central** and, if so, that it’s patched and checked for intrusion (see previous page).
- ✓ Make sure no **control panels, cameras or admin devices** are exposed to the internet, and change any **default passwords**.
- ✓ Remind staff to **never approve a login code or prompt** they didn’t start themselves.
- ✓ Verify your **backups** ran, and that at least one copy is offline and recently tested.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 10 August 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a **watchful eye** changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

241 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2025

\$4.44M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2025

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion
the way in

Foothold
quietly settling in

Lateral movement
spreading across systems

Impact
data theft / ransomware

↑ The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES



Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.



Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.



Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the MSP-tool and phishing attacks in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.



Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Check your IT provider's remote tools

Ask whoever manages your IT whether they use **N-able N-central** and, if so, that it's been **updated to 2026.3.1.7** and checked for signs of intrusion — the flaw let attackers reach client machines through it.

GOOD HABIT

Keep tested, offline backups

Keep at least one **backup that's offline or off-site** and **test that it actually restores**. When ransomware or a bad change strikes, a clean, recent backup is often the fastest way back — and the one thing attackers can't quietly encrypt.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at hello@dpg-cyber.com.